“Faith means never asking questions.”

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Where it often comes from

Being told to “just believe” when you asked honest questions as a child. Leaders who treated questions as rebellion. Fear that asking will lead you away from God. A family or church where certainty was valued over understanding. Embarrassment about not knowing answers.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is full of faithful people who asked God hard questions. Habakkuk cried, “How long, O LORD?” Mary asked the angel, “How can this be?” The psalmists asked why and how long. God invited people to reason with Him. Peter tells believers to be ready to give a reason for their hope. Honest questions, brought to God with humility, can deepen faith rather than destroy it.

> *“How long, O LORD, must I call for help but You do not hear, or cry out to You, ‘Violence!’ but You do not save?”* **(Habakkuk 1:2)**.

Also see

> “How long, O LORD? Will You forget me forever? How long will You hide Your face from me? How long must I wrestle in my soul, with sorrow in my heart each day? How long will my enemy dominate me?” **(Psalm 13:1–2)**.

> “‘How can this be,’ Mary asked the angel, ‘since I am a virgin?’” **(Luke 1:34)**.

> “Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him” **(James 1:5)**.

> “But in your hearts sanctify Christ as Lord. Always be prepared to give a defense to everyone who asks you the reason for the hope that is in you. But respond with gentleness and respect” **(1 Peter 3:15)**.

Common self-statements

- Asking questions means I don’t trust God.
- Good Christians just accept everything.
- If I start asking, I’ll lose my faith.
- God is offended by my questions.
- Thinking too much is dangerous.
- I shouldn’t need to understand.

Common logical errors

- **All-or-nothing thinking:** Believing you must either never question or abandon faith.
- **Fear-based thinking:** Avoiding questions because you fear where they might lead.
- **Should statements:** “I should accept everything without asking.”
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking the many questions asked by faithful people in Scripture.

Challenging questions

- Did Habakkuk, Mary, and the psalmists ask God questions?
- Did God punish them for asking?
- What does Peter say I should be ready to give?
- Is my faith in God, or in never having questions?
- What does James 1:5 say I can ask for?
- Who taught me that questions are dangerous?
- What question have I been afraid to ask?

Truth summary

> Faith does not mean never asking questions. Faithful people in Scripture brought hard questions to God. I can ask honestly and humbly, seek wisdom, and trust God even when some answers do not come. My faith rests on God, not on avoiding questions.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Faith
- Wisdom
- Truth
- Seeking
- Doubt

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Truth
- Belief/Salvation

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Faith means never asking questions"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Faith means never asking questions." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Did faithful people in Scripture ask questions?
- ☐ Did God punish them for asking?
- ☐ What does Peter say to be ready to give?
- ☐ Is my faith in God or in not asking?
- ☐ What can I ask God for, according to James?
- ☐ What question have I been afraid to ask?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Faith can ask honest questions.
- ☐ God welcomes my humble questions.
- ☐ I can ask God for wisdom.
- ☐ My faith rests on God, not on having every answer.
- ☐ Questions can deepen my faith.
- ☐ I can be ready to give a reason for my hope.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Habakkuk 1:2**
  "How long, O LORD, must I call for help but You do not hear, or cry out to You, 'Violence!' but You do not save?"
- [ ] **Psalm 13:1–2**
  "How long, O LORD? Will You forget me forever? How long will You hide Your face from me? How long must I wrestle in my soul, with sorrow in my heart each day? How long will my enemy dominate me?"
- [ ] **Luke 1:34**
  "'How can this be,' Mary asked the angel, 'since I am a virgin?'"
- [ ] **James 1:5**
  "Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him."
- [ ] **1 Peter 3:15**
  "But in your hearts sanctify Christ as Lord. Always be prepared to give a defense to everyone who asks you the reason for the hope that is in you. But respond with gentleness and respect."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Question journal:** Each day, write one honest question for God and one thing I learned while seeking.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, James 1:5 becomes: "Now if **Sarah** lacks wisdom, **she** should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to **her**."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write down a question you've been afraid to ask,** and bring it to God in prayer.
- ☐ **Read the whole book of Habakkuk (three short chapters),** and notice how his questions lead to trust.
- ☐ **Ask your pastor or a mature Christian** one honest question this week.
- ☐ **Look up what the Bible says about your question** using a study Bible or concordance.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Faith means never asking questions": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One question I brought to God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Faith means never asking questions.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that You welcome my honest questions. Help me reject the lie that faith means never asking questions. Give me humility, wisdom, and courage to seek You, and help me trust You even when I don't have every answer. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.